

Existentialism — Hard MCQ Questions

74-question closed-book practice bank · no answer key

Attempt closed-book. Record option, reasoning and confidence. Answers are intentionally absent.

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MCQ 1

When Existentialism is treated as a philosophical family, which classification preserves the projects of Kierkegaard, Sartre and Heidegger?

A. Kierkegaard develops religious inwardness, Sartre develops atheistic freedom, and Heidegger pursues fundamental ontology. B. Kierkegaard develops atheistic freedom, Sartre pursues fundamental ontology, and Heidegger defends religious inwardness. C. All three thinkers defend a single doctrine, with differences caused merely by their different philosophical vocabularies. D. Kierkegaard and Heidegger share Sartre's humanism, while Sartre denies freedom altogether.

MCQ 2

How should Nietzsche be used inside the printed Existentialism syllabus item on Kierkegaard, Sartre and Heidegger?

A. Nietzsche owns Heidegger's account of being-in-the-world because Heidegger later interpreted Nietzsche extensively. B. Nietzsche should replace Kierkegaard because both criticize systematic philosophy and inherited Christianity. C. Nietzsche supplies the canonical three stages of existence that structure Kierkegaard's account of inwardness. D. Nietzsche remains bounded enrichment, not a printed owner-thinker for this syllabus item.

MCQ 3

What is the defensible role of Camus's absurdity in an Existentialism answer confined to the canonical owner material?

A. Camus provides a bounded comparison, not the shared doctrine of the printed thinkers. B. Camus's absurdity establishes Sartre's transcendental ego as the permanent subject underlying intentional acts. C. Camus's absurdity is Heidegger's name for the ontological difference between Being and particular beings. D. Camus's absurdity is identical with Kierkegaard's paradox of faith, supplying the religious stage's final content.

MCQ 4

Which contrast best distinguishes the religious and atheistic variants within the existentialist family?

A. Heidegger treats atheism as the proven conclusion of fundamental ontology, whereas Sartre leaves God's existence undecided. B. Kierkegaard grounds selfhood before God, whereas Sartre begins from atheism and makes value depend on situated choice. C. Sartre grounds faith in the absurd, whereas Kierkegaard makes consciousness a nihilating emptiness without an ego. D. Kierkegaard and Sartre both derive moral values from a divine artisan, whereas Heidegger denies human finitude.

MCQ 5

Who owns the formula 'existence precedes essence' in the canonical Existentialism package?

A. Kierkegaard coins the formula in the Postscript, while Sartre and Heidegger merely translate his Danish expression. B. All existentialists use the formula identically because they reject every conception of human nature. C. Sartre owns the formula, Kierkegaard does not use it, and Heidegger rejects its humanistic metaphysical inversion. D. Heidegger coins the formula in Being and Time, while Sartre later removes its ontological meaning.

MCQ 6

Why does Heidegger resist being classified through Sartre's existential humanism in the Letter on Humanism?

A. Heidegger rejects philosophical analysis of human existence because Dasein refers exclusively to non-human entities. B. Heidegger accepts Sartre's account of self-creation but argues that it should be supplemented by a divine command theory. C. Heidegger treats humanism as mistaken because it gives insufficient attention to empirical psychology and biology. D. Heidegger says Sartre's reversal remains metaphysical because it keeps human subjectivity central.

MCQ 7

What does Kierkegaard's expression 'the single individual' primarily oppose?

A. It opposes personal commitment by requiring the person to identify principally with public opinion. B. It opposes religious inwardness because the individual can become spirit only through institutional membership. C. It rejects ethical obligation as such because individuality is valid only in aesthetic enjoyment. D. It opposes the absorption of concrete responsibility into the crowd or a completed speculative system.

MCQ 8

In Johannes Climacus's account, what does 'truth is subjectivity' mean?

A. Logical validity varies with private feeling because objective standards belong to the anonymous crowd. B. A factual statement becomes true whenever a believer experiences sufficiently intense conviction about it. C. Existential truth requires passionate inward appropriation, not detached propositional possession alone. D. Religious truth is demonstrable without risk once speculative philosophy completes a systematic proof of God.

MCQ 9

Which qualification prevents Kierkegaard's 'truth is subjectivity' from collapsing into relativism?

A. The thesis governs existential appropriation without displacing objective truth in logic, science or factual inquiry. B. The thesis makes collective agreement the final test of truth because the crowd corrects individual bias. C. The thesis treats sincere belief as salvific even when it evades responsibility and the God-relation. D. The thesis denies that propositions possess content independently of the emotional intensity with which they are asserted.

MCQ 10

Why can Kierkegaard also write that 'subjectivity is untruth'?

A. Subjectivity is untruth because the aesthetic sphere already provides complete reconciliation without ethical commitment. B. Subjectivity is untruth because first-person experience is an illusion produced by the anonymous public. C. Subjectivity is untruth because Kierkegaard finally abandons faith and accepts Hegel's completed objective system. D. The self can remain in untruth before God, so inwardness is a task rather than a guarantee.

MCQ 11

How does Kierkegaard's anti-Hegelian argument challenge a completed system of spirit?

A. A logical system may be possible, but an existential system cannot contain the living thinker who must choose, suffer and die. B. Kierkegaard proposes a rival total system in which the religious sphere dialectically absorbs the lower standpoints. C. A completed system fails because Hegel used examples from history instead of mathematical demonstrations. D. The concrete person is preserved by being fully sublated into Absolute Spirit, which removes the need for personal decision.

MCQ 12

Why is pseudonymity philosophically important in Kierkegaard's authorship?

A. Pseudonyms indirectly stage existence-possibilities and must not be flattened into Kierkegaard's direct doctrine. B. Pseudonyms serve merely as legal protection from censorship and are unrelated to indirect communication. C. Pseudonyms conceal one systematic doctrine, and its propositions can be attributed to Kierkegaard without qualification. D. Pseudonyms prove that existential truth is best transmitted as an impersonal result detached from the reader's appropriation.

MCQ 13

How should Kierkegaard's aesthetic, ethical and religious 'stages' be understood?

A. They are social classes ordered by wealth, public office and ecclesiastical authority rather than modes of existing. B. They are biological ages through which everyone matures irreversibly from youth to religious adulthood. C. They are Hegelian moments; their contradictions are necessarily sublated into one final speculative synthesis. D. They are qualitative spheres of existence joined by decision and possible leap, not compulsory chronological phases.

MCQ 14

What most clearly characterizes Kierkegaard's aesthetic sphere?

A. It pursues immediacy and novelty without binding commitment, risking boredom and fragmentation. B. It analyses Dasein's equipmental involvement as the primary disclosure of a referential world. C. It stands singularly before God through the double movement of resignation and restored finite attachment. D. It accepts universal obligation, marriage and vocation as the transparent form through which the self becomes responsible.

MCQ 15

Within Kierkegaard's ethical sphere, which combination of commitment and limitation is accurate?

A. It suspends ethical universality through Abraham's singular relation to God and thereby completes religious existence. B. It chooses universal commitments but encounters guilt because ethical demands remain imperfectly fulfilled. C. It identifies authenticity with anticipatory resoluteness toward one's ownmost possibility of death. D. It rejects universal obligation in favour of episodic pleasure, irony and avoidance of personal continuity.

MCQ 16

What is staged by Abraham in Fear and Trembling under Johannes de Silentio's authorship?

A. The aesthetic refusal of commitment that makes enjoyment and novelty the sole standards of a meaningful life. B. The ontological disclosure that a broken tool becomes present-at-hand when an equipmental network is disturbed. C. The ethical proof that universal duty in each case overrides any singular relation and excludes every paradoxical exception. D. It stages faith's paradoxical suspension of the ethical without licensing private violence.

MCQ 17

What does Kierkegaard mean by anxiety as the 'dizziness of freedom'?

A. Anxiety is the calm certainty that ethical rules mechanically determine a person's choice before action. B. Anxiety confronts freedom's indeterminate possibility rather than one determinate object. C. Anxiety is the loss of consciousness produced when the transcendental ego suspends the existence of the external world. D. Anxiety is simply a stronger physiological fear directed at a clearly identified danger within the surrounding world.

MCQ 18

How does Anti-Climacus define despair in The Sickness unto Death?

A. Despair is a misrelation in the self's relation to itself and to the power that established the self. B. Despair is Heidegger's account of the public now-series that conceals primordial ecstatic temporality. C. Despair is a temporary emotional sadness cured by moving from theoretical knowledge to empirical psychology. D. Despair is Sartre's practical rule that action should rely only on probabilities under one's control.

MCQ 19

Which account correctly distinguishes Kierkegaard's anxiety from his despair?

A. Anxiety and despair are interchangeable translations of one Danish term, without a conceptual distinction. B. Anxiety belongs to the ethical stage, whereas despair appears after complete religious reconciliation. C. Anxiety concerns the self's fixed essence, whereas despair concerns a determinate external danger encountered in ordinary life. D. Anxiety concerns freedom's possibility, whereas despair concerns the self's failed relation to itself and its grounding power.

MCQ 20

How should the phrase 'leap of faith' be used when discussing Kierkegaard?

A. It should be presented as Hegel's term for the necessary mediation from ethical life to Absolute Spirit. B. It is an English summary; Kierkegaard writes of the leap and of faith separately. C. It should be quoted as the exact title of a chapter written by Johannes Climacus in Being and Time. D. It should be treated as Sartre's formula for abandoning determinism through an arbitrary act without facticity.

MCQ 21

What does Sartre's paper-knife example establish in Existentialism Is a Humanism?

A. An artefact has a prior design, whereas a person without a divine maker exists before defining a project or essence. B. Human beings possess fixed functions in exactly the same manner as manufactured instruments. C. Heidegger's Dasein is best understood as an artefact located spatially inside a container-like external world. D. Consciousness becomes authentic by copying the stable self-identity of a useful material object.

MCQ 22

What role does atheism play in Sartre's argument that existence precedes essence?

A. Atheism abolishes facticity, making bodily, historical and social conditions irrelevant to human projects. B. Atheism guarantees objective moral values because choice discovers a pre-existing intelligible heaven. C. Atheism removes a divine human blueprint and leaves persons responsible for situated projects. D. Atheism is the conclusion reached after Heidegger's fundamental ontology proves divinity impossible.

MCQ 23

Why does Sartre call existentialism a humanism?

A. Human beings receive their moral values through a transcendental ego that constitutes the world before practical involvement. B. Human beings possess an immutable rational essence that predetermines valid projects before existence begins. C. Human beings surpass themselves through projects and bear responsibility for the image of humanity implied by their choices. D. Human beings become authentic by withdrawing from relations with others and from their historical situation.

MCQ 24

What is Heidegger's central objection to Sartre's humanist reading of existence and essence?

A. The reversal identifies equipment as ready-to-hand and thereby makes theoretical cognition more primordial than practical coping. B. The reversal still treats the human subject as the centre and leaves the inherited metaphysical pair fundamentally unquestioned. C. The reversal accepts Kierkegaard's religious paradox, making atheistic freedom logically impossible. D. The reversal gives excessive priority to Being and neglects the autonomous creativity of an inner transcendental ego.

MCQ 25

Which statement prevents Sartrean self-making from becoming arbitrary choice?

A. Projects become justified only after an objective moral code is discovered in a timeless intelligible realm. B. Projects interpret facticity through responsible commitment rather than escaping constraint. C. Projects cancel bodily, historical and social conditions whenever consciousness declares itself independent of them. D. Projects are arbitrary because choices bear nothing beyond the chooser's momentary preference.

MCQ 26

How does Sartre characterize being-in-itself, or en-soi?

A. It is pre-reflective consciousness that projects possibilities and does not coincide with its factual past. B. It is Kierkegaard's account of a self transparently grounded in the power that established it. C. It is full, opaque and self-identical being that is what it is, without the nihilating distance of consciousness. D. It is Heidegger's term for Dasein's practical involvement in a network of ready-to-hand equipment.

MCQ 27

Which description identifies Sartre's being-for-itself, or pour-soi, without turning it into a substance?

A. It is the religious individual with an ethical duty suspended by an absolute relation to God. B. It is a completed substance with a fixed essence that determines future projects and moral responsibilities. C. It is conscious non-self-coincidence that nihilates the given and projects possibilities beyond its facticity. D. It is anonymous public interpretation and conformity through which Heidegger's Dasein loses itself in everydayness.

MCQ 28

What does Sartre mean by saying consciousness 'is what it is not and is not what it is'?

A. Consciousness is a stable substance; its future follows analytically from a complete and immutable human essence. B. Consciousness alternates between Husserl's epoché and Heidegger's ready-to-hand equipment without preserving intentionality. C. Consciousness is a logical contradiction that neither exists nor possesses any directed relation to objects in the world. D. Consciousness projects toward unrealized possibilities and cannot coincide completely with its past or present facticity.

MCQ 29

What does Sartre's Pierre-in-the-café example show about nothingness?

A. Pierre's absence proves that the café and its surrounding physical world cease to exist whenever consciousness expects something else. B. Pierre's absence establishes that a determinate fear and objectless anxiety possess exactly the same intentional structure. C. Pierre's experienced absence organizes the perceptual field, showing that negation is disclosed rather than merely added by later language. D. Pierre's absence demonstrates that Husserl's transcendental ego is the substantial cause of all objects appearing in consciousness.

MCQ 30

What does Sartre mean by describing consciousness as 'nothing'?

A. Consciousness lacks thing-like content and fixed essence while remaining intentional and self-aware. B. Consciousness is an empty physical container that receives internal images copied from independently existing external objects. C. Consciousness is the transcendental ego understood as a permanent substance that remains identical beneath changing acts. D. Consciousness is literally nonexistent, so references to freedom, perception and responsibility are convenient fictional descriptions.

MCQ 31

What is Sartre's claim in The Transcendence of the Ego?

A. The ego is an immanent substance discovered before intentional acts and responsible for producing their objects. B. The ego is the divine artisan; its concept of humanity explains why essence necessarily precedes existence. C. The ego is a reflected transcendent object, not an inhabitant needed to unify

consciousness. D. The ego is identical with Heidegger's Dasein because both terms designate a Cartesian subject prior to any world.

MCQ 32

What phenomenological commitment do Husserl and Sartre share despite their disagreement about the ego?

A. Both reject pre-reflective awareness and treat reflection as the sole source of any consciousness whatsoever. B. Both hold that the transcendental ego is an empirical personality produced principally by social roles and public language. C. Both identify consciousness with a self-identical substance, with contents causally sealed from the external world. D. Both accept intentionality and reject the model of consciousness as a container filled with internal representations.

MCQ 33

How does Sartre's notion of consciousness differ most sharply from Husserl's later transcendental account?

A. Sartre identifies the ego with bodily facticity, whereas Husserl identifies it with Heidegger's network of ready-to-hand equipment. B. Sartre makes consciousness non-egological; Husserl retains a constituting pure ego with habitualities. C. Sartre makes freedom irrelevant to consciousness, whereas Husserl derives radical choice from the absence of a stable self. D. Sartre rejects intentionality, whereas Husserl treats consciousness as directed beyond itself toward transcendent objects.

MCQ 34

What does Sartre mean by saying that human beings are 'condemned to be free'?

A. They possess unlimited physical power to realize any project regardless of bodily, social or historical conditions. B. They did not choose to exist, yet once existing they cannot escape taking responsibility for how they take up situations. C. They are punished by God with freedom after violating an objective moral law established before human existence. D. They may surrender freedom completely by refusing reflection and allowing inherited roles to determine future action.

MCQ 35

Why does Sartre deny that a motive determines action before freedom?

A. A circumstance becomes a motive through meaning conferred within a freely adopted project. B. A motive lacks causal power because all somatic and psychological events are illusions generated by an immaterial soul. C. A motive determines action when it has been verified by the transcendental ego through phenomenological reduction. D. A motive determines action mechanically whenever it arises from scarcity, seriality or the practico-inert.

MCQ 36

How are facticity and transcendence related in Sartre's account of situated freedom?

A. Facticity supplies the given conditions, while transcendence is the projective surpassing that interprets those conditions without erasing them. B. Facticity and transcendence are two names for the self-identical plenitude of being-in-itself. C. Facticity is an illusion created by bad faith, while transcendence gives consciousness unrestricted control over external events. D. Facticity names Heidegger's future ecstasis, while transcendence names Kierkegaard's ethical stage of universal duty.

MCQ 37

Why does Sartre regard refusing to choose as a choice?

A. Refusal suspends consciousness completely, creating a period during which responsibility and projects disappear. B. Deferral or conformity still takes up a stance and lets a situation or another person decide within one's project. C. Refusal follows a moral law that separates passive non-choice from responsible action. D. Refusal converts the pour-soi into an en-soi, fixing future conduct through an acquired social essence.

MCQ 38

What does Sartre mean by saying 'in choosing myself I choose man'?

A. A choice presents an image of humanity as worth choosing, giving personal commitment a universal dimension and producing anguish. B. A choice remains confined to private preference because values are wholly incommunicable between separate consciousnesses. C. A choice discovers a biologically fixed essence common to persons and removes responsibility for its consequences. D. A choice becomes valid only after the crowd confirms that the same action is statistically preferred by most people.

MCQ 39

How do anguish, abandonment and despair function in Sartre's popular exposition?

A. Anguish abolishes freedom, abandonment restores a divine blueprint, and despair guarantees that projects will succeed. B. Anguish discloses responsibility, abandonment the absence of given values, and despair the limit of relying on outcomes beyond action. C. Anguish discloses a determinate danger, abandonment proves that God exists, and despair describes Kierkegaard's misrelation of the self. D. Anguish is Heidegger's ready-to-hand equipment, abandonment is das Man, and despair is ordinary clock-time.

MCQ 40

What is the significance of Sartre's Critique of Dialectical Reason for his earlier freedom thesis?

A. It incorporates scarcity, seriality and the practico-inert while retaining conditioned freedom. B. It retracts freedom principally and replaces existentialism with a deterministic account in which projects cease to play any role. C. It converts Sartre to Kierkegaard's religious stage and grounds responsibility in obedience to a divine command. D. It repeats Being and Nothingness without addressing social mediation, historical institutions or material constraint.

MCQ 41

What is bad faith in Sartre's Being and Nothingness?

A. It is Heidegger's structural falling into public time, unrelated to responsibility or self-deception. B. It is repression by a fully unconscious censor operating independently of pre-reflective awareness. C. It is self-deception that denies the tension of facticity and transcendence in order to flee the burden of freedom. D. It is an ordinary lie told to another person by a consciousness that transparently accepts its own freedom.

MCQ 42

Why is Sartre's over-scripted waiter an example of bad faith?

A. He denies bodily and social facts by pretending that roles and situations are irrelevant to his project. B. He suspends universal ethical duty for an absolute relation to God and enters Kierkegaard's religious sphere through a singular exception. C. He performs the social role as though it exhausted his being, reducing transcendence to a fixed occupational facticity. D. He experiences the Other's look at a keyhole and discovers that human relations are necessarily cooperative.

MCQ 43

What structure of bad faith appears in Sartre's example of the woman on a date?

A. She becomes present-at-hand because a tool breaks, revealing the referential whole of Heidegger's surrounding world. B. She treats her hand as a passive thing while postponing the gesture's meaning, simultaneously manipulating facticity and transcendence. C. She identifies completely with her chosen project, accepting both bodily facticity and responsible transcendence without evasion. D. She confronts the paradox of faith through infinite resignation and the restoration of a finite good.

MCQ 44

How does Sartre explain self-deception without appealing to a Freudian unconscious?

A. Public language determines belief, eliminating the first-person awareness from which self-deception could arise. B. The transcendental ego divides into two substances, one permanently deceiving the other through internal representations. C. A separate unconscious censor knows the truth and hides it from a wholly ignorant conscious ego. D. Pre-reflective consciousness can evade a truth it tacitly lives because the pour-soi lacks self-coincidence.

MCQ 45

What does Sartre's keyhole example establish about the Look?

A. Hearing another approach transforms absorbed spying into shameful awareness of oneself as an object for another subject. B. Anticipating the observer's death individualizes Dasein and calls it from the crowd into religious faith. C. Breaking the keyhole makes the door present-at-hand, supposedly proving that practical equipment derives from theory. D. Remaining alone at the keyhole reveals a transcendental ego that constitutes the absent observer as a noematic object in reflection.

MCQ 46

Why does Sartre describe conflict as the original meaning of being-for-others?

A. Conflict disappears once a person sincerely identifies with a social role and abandons transcendence. B. Attempts to possess another's freedom or reduce the other to an object frustrate the recognition each project seeks. C. The Other is constituted by analogy within a transcendental ego, excluding any lived experience of objectification or conflict. D. Being-with guarantees reciprocal recognition because subjects and objects harmonize before any concrete encounter.

MCQ 47

How should Sartre's line 'hell is other people' be interpreted?

A. It states Heidegger's doctrine that being-with is a deficient mode eliminated by anticipatory resoluteness. B. It expresses Kierkegaard's view that the crowd cannot contain an ethically responsible individual. C. It concerns distorted relations under another's judgment, not every possible human relation. D. It establishes that other minds do not exist and that apparent social relations are projections of solitary consciousness.

MCQ 48

What is the most defensible positive meaning of Sartrean authenticity?

A. Authenticity copies Heidegger's non-moral resoluteness exactly, erasing Sartre's distinct account of bad faith. B. Authenticity owns both facticity and transcendence without pretending to be a fixed thing or a freedom detached from situation. C. Authenticity selects whichever spontaneous preference feels strongest because freedom removes responsibility and constraint. D. Authenticity abolishes the Look by making other people unable to perceive or judge the self.

MCQ 49

What is Heidegger's ontological difference?

A. It is Kierkegaard's distinction between objective propositions and passionate religious appropriation. B. It distinguishes Being's intelligibility from any particular being disclosed within it. C. It is Husserl's distinction between the natural attitude and the transcendental ego reached through reduction. D. It is Sartre's distinction between a self-identical object and a nihilating consciousness that projects beyond itself.

MCQ 50

Why does Heidegger select Dasein for the inquiry into Being?

A. Dasein is a biological species; measurable properties supply a complete empirical definition of existence. B. Dasein is a divine artisan; its concept determines the essence and function of created human beings. C. Dasein's own Being is at issue for it, and it already possesses a pre-ontological understanding of Being. D. Dasein is a detached substance; internal representations provide certainty before any encounter with a world.

MCQ 51

What does Heidegger mean by being-in-the-world?

A. It is the spatial placement of a self-contained mind inside a container composed of independently existing physical things. B. It is Husserl's transcendental reduction from worldly experience to a constituting ego outside practical concern. C. It is Sartre's name for consciousness introducing nothingness into a field of self-identical being. D. It is a unitary structure of practical involvement that precedes the separation of an inner subject from external objects.

MCQ 52

How are ready-to-hand and present-at-hand related in Heidegger's equipment analysis?

A. Absorbed equipment-use is primary; detached property-observation emerges through disruption or thematization. B. Both modes are identical because a hammer's properties and its place in a workshop are disclosed in precisely the same way. C. Detached theoretical observation is primordial, while practical use is a later subjective interpretation added to neutral objects. D. Ready-to-hand names Sartrean consciousness, while present-at-hand names Kierkegaard's ethical commitment under universal duty.

MCQ 53

What is the philosophical point of Heidegger's broken-hammer analysis?

A. A broken tool loses its worldly relations and proves that equipment does not possess practical significance. B. Breakdown reveals the equipmental network from which theoretical objects are derivatively disclosed. C. A disturbance suspends the world's existence and discloses Husserl's pure transcendental ego as the residual subject. D. A broken tool reveals that consciousness is nothing because material objects cease to possess self-identical being.

MCQ 54

Which structures constitute Dasein's disclosedness in Being and Time?

A. Aesthetic pleasure, ethical duty and religious faith are existentialia arranged as Heidegger's necessary stages. B. Attunement, understanding as projection and discourse articulate how Dasein finds itself and opens a meaningful world. C. Anguish, abandonment and despair are the three ecstases through which ordinary time becomes measurable. D. Sensation, judgment and inference form empirical categories through which a worldless mind constructs external reality.

MCQ 55

What does Heidegger mean by Care, or Sorge, as the Being of Dasein?

A. Care is a moral command requiring Dasein to choose benevolent rather than harmful actions. B. Care is a psychological feeling of worry that appears intermittently alongside otherwise self-contained rational cognition. C. Care unifies being-ahead-of-itself, already-being-in-a-world and being-alongside entities encountered within that world. D. Care is the transcendental ego's synthesis of inner sensations into enduring noematic objects through phenomenological reduction.

MCQ 56

What does Heidegger mean by das Man, or 'the they'?

A. It is Kierkegaard's knight of faith who appears ordinary while maintaining an absolute relation to God. B. It is an identifiable malicious person who directly causes another person's inauthenticity. C. It is anonymous publicness through which what one says, thinks and does becomes levelled into everyday conformity. D. It is Sartre's universal image of humanity chosen whenever the for-itself undertakes a responsible project.

MCQ 57

How should Heidegger's notion of falling, or Verfallen, be understood?

A. It is the phenomenological reduction by which consciousness brackets practical involvement and returns to a pure ego. B. It is a voluntary moral crime committed whenever an authentic person consciously chooses an evil project. C. It is the empirical event of organismic death that ends projection and abolishes temporality. D. It is structural absorption in public concern, not a theological fall from moral purity.

MCQ 58

What does Heideggerian anxiety disclose in Being and Time?

A. The collapse of ordinary significance reveals being-in-the-world as such and individualizes Dasein from das Man. B. A clearly identified threatening object reveals the safest practical route for escaping danger within the surrounding world. C. A divine command reveals the religious stage and guarantees that universal ethical duty may be suspended. D. A psychological cause reveals that moods are internal colorings added to an otherwise neutral world.

MCQ 59

What does being-toward-death disclose for Heidegger?

A. Death is Dasein's ownmost, non-relational, certain and indefinite possibility, which individualizes rather than recommends suicide. B. Death is an illusion produced by the crowd and disappears when Dasein attains anticipatory resoluteness. C. Death is a present-at-hand biological event, and its measurable occurrence exhausts its philosophical significance. D. Death is a determinate object of fear that provides a substantive moral code for evaluating possible choices.

MCQ 60

What is the role of the call of conscience in Heidegger's account of authenticity?

A. Its public instructions supply a universal ethical code that determines which concrete political commitments are authentically correct. B. Its theological voice reveals God's command and moves the individual from the ethical sphere into Kierkegaard's religious stage. C. Its silent summons recalls Dasein from das Man to its groundless responsibility and prepares anticipatory resoluteness without issuing moral rules. D. Its reflective certainty brackets the world and discloses a transcendental ego independent of thrownness and being-with.

MCQ 61

How are authenticity and inauthenticity related as modes of Dasein's being?

A. Authenticity defines Dasein's essence from the beginning, while inauthenticity belongs instead to entities lacking any understanding of Being. B. Authenticity is moral goodness, while inauthenticity is culpable wickedness measured by a universal ethical law. C. Authenticity removes Dasein from social existence, while inauthenticity alone preserves being-with and practical involvement. D. Both are possible modifications of being-in-the-world; authenticity owns thrown possibilities, while inauthenticity disperses them in das Man.

MCQ 62

How do Heidegger's three temporal ecstases map onto the structure of Care?

A. Future maps to already-in, having-been to being-alongside, and present to ahead-of-itself. B. The temporal ecstases are structurally unrelated to Care because Care is merely a psychological attitude. C. Future maps to being-alongside, having-been to ahead-of-itself, and present to already-in. D. Future maps

to ahead-of-itself, having-been to already-in, and present to being-alongside entities.

MCQ 63

Why does Heidegger grant priority to the future within primordial temporality?

A. Future events causally determine present choices because Dasein possesses certain knowledge of everything that will occur. B. The future abolishes having-been and present involvement once Dasein withdraws from worldly relations. C. Projection toward the ownmost possibility of death gathers thrown existence and makes authentic historicity possible. D. The future is a container of not-yet-present moments that becomes real as the moving present reaches each one.

MCQ 64

What distinguishes primordial temporality from vulgar or ordinary time in Heidegger?

A. Primordial temporality is finite and ecstatic, whereas ordinary time is a derived public sequence of measurable nows. B. Primordial temporality belongs to objects, whereas ordinary time belongs exclusively to authentic Dasein's projects. C. Primordial temporality is an infinite series of present instants, whereas ordinary time unifies future, having-been and present. D. Primordial temporality is Newtonian absolute time, whereas ordinary time is the private feeling of duration within consciousness.

MCQ 65

What is Heidegger's concept of historicity, or *Geschichtlichkeit*?

A. History is Sartre's claim that past facticity mechanically determines the meaning of present and future projects. B. History is an external chronology of present-at-hand events unrelated to projection, inheritance or authenticity. C. Dasein inherits possibilities from a shared past and projects them anew, so history belongs to its temporal way of existing. D. History is the Hegelian completion of Absolute Spirit that dissolves singular possibility into necessary progress.

MCQ 66

Why is ordinary clock-time called derivative rather than simply false in Heidegger?

A. Clock-time is false because events cannot be measured and numerical sequence is produced by bad faith. B. Clock-time is primordial because detached theoretical observation in each case precedes practical involvement with equipment. C. Clock-time is religious because its sequence of moments culminates in Kierkegaard's paradox of the eternal entering time. D. Public dating and measurement arise from more primordial temporal involvement, yet remain practically valid for worldly coordination.

MCQ 67

How should fear and existential anxiety be distinguished across the existentialist tradition?

A. Fear and anxiety differ only in physiological intensity and lack distinct philosophical or disclosive significance. B. Fear is objectless, while anxiety identifies one threatening entity and remains within ordinary practical concern. C. Fear is uniquely Sartrean, while anxiety belongs exclusively to Kierkegaard and does not appear in Heidegger's ontology. D. Fear has a determinate worldly object, while anxiety lacks one and discloses possibility, freedom or being-in-the-world according to the thinker.

MCQ 68

Which comparison of existential moods is accurate?

A. Kierkegaard treats despair as controlled outcomes, Heidegger treats anxiety as fear of death, and Sartre treats anguish as physical danger. B. Kierkegaard links anxiety to possibility, Heidegger to world-collapse, and Sartre to responsibility before freedom. C. Kierkegaard links anxiety to equipment failure, Heidegger to divine abandonment, and Sartre to the teleological suspension. D. Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre use one identical clinical diagnosis, with content unchanged across their projects.

MCQ 69

Which examples most accurately distinguish Sartrean anguish from Heideggerian anxiety?

A. Sartre's transcendental ego reveals constitution, while Heidegger's *Pierre* reveals absence within an intentional field. B. Sartre's cliff and gambler reveal freedom, while Heidegger's collapse of significance reveals being-in-the-world as such. C. Sartre's broken hammer reveals ready-to-hand equipment, while Heidegger's paper-knife reveals a missing divine artisan. D. Sartre's Abraham reveals the paradox of faith, while Heidegger's waiter reveals identification with social facticity.

MCQ 70

What is the strongest ethical criticism of Heideggerian authenticity?

A. Its substantive moral code is so detailed that it eliminates room for individual projection or historical interpretation. B. Its dependence on divine command makes it unavailable to anyone outside Kierkegaard's religious sphere. C. Its formal account tells *Dasein* to own a commitment without supplying criteria for which commitments deserve endorsement. D. Its reduction of freedom to physical ability prevents any distinction between facticity and transcendence.

MCQ 71

What is the strongest social criticism of early Sartrean freedom?

A. It makes being-with the primary ontology, preventing any explanation of individual projects or bad faith. B. It treats social roles as natural essences established by a divine artisan before individuals begin to exist. C. It can understate how oppression, trauma and material structures restrict action and even the intelligibility of alternatives. D. It gives material scarcity complete causal power, eliminating responsibility and interpretive agency.

MCQ 72

What is the central epistemic criticism of Kierkegaard's religious leap?

A. The leap is excessively rational because it derives religious faith by necessary steps from a completed logical system. B. The leap abolishes inwardness by making collective agreement the principal criterion of existential truth. C. The leap reduces faith to theoretical observation of present-at-hand objects without personal risk or commitment. D. The leap may become fideistic if passionate commitment lacks adequate rational accountability or publicly assessable limits.

MCQ 73

Which comparison of authenticity across Kierkegaard, Sartre and Heidegger is defensible?

A. All three thinkers treat authenticity as withdrawal from social relations, bodily facticity and inherited historical possibilities. B. Kierkegaard and Heidegger make authenticity atheistic self-creation, while Sartre grounds it in a paradoxical relation to God. C. Kierkegaard, Sartre and Heidegger define authenticity as obedience to one universal ethical code established independently of existence. D. Kierkegaard grounds selfhood before God, Sartre opposes bad faith through situated freedom, and Heidegger describes non-moral ownedness of finite possibility.

MCQ 74

How should the Husserl-Heidegger boundary be handled in the 2018 epoché question?

A. Epoché must be attributed to Heidegger as his method for reaching Dasein before any practical involvement with a world. B. Epoché must be attributed to Sartre because nihilation and phenomenological reduction are two names for one operation. C. Epoché and transcendental reduction must be attributed to Husserl, while primary ownership rests here because Heidegger's being-in-the-world carries the main burden. D. Epoché should be omitted because cross-topic concepts cannot appear in an answer owned by Existentialism.